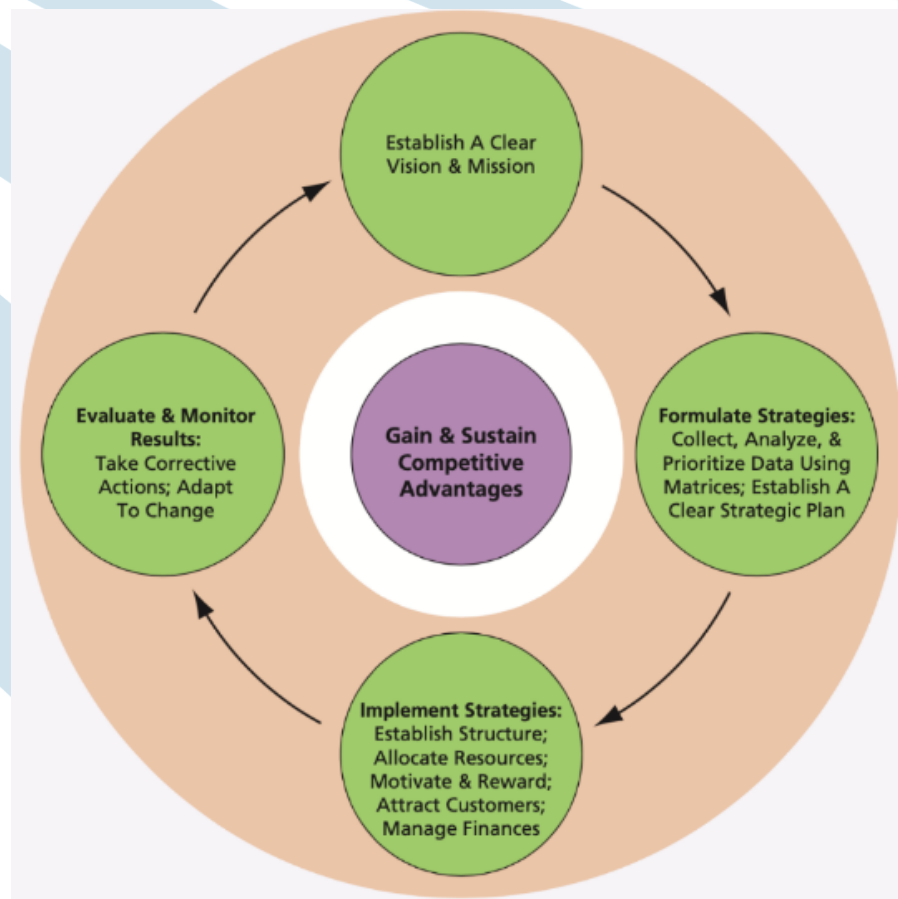


BUMG4201 – STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT

Project Report

Marks = 100 || Weight = 25%

Submission Deadline: Sunday, 25th March 2026



S2/2025-2026

Strategic Roadmap for Competitive Advantage An Evaluation of Organization Operating in Oman

PROJECT OVERVIEW

This project assesses students' ability to apply strategic management concepts to a real or structured organizational context in Oman through a comprehensive evaluation of the entire strategic management process. Working in groups, students will analyze organizational resources, capabilities, and competitive positioning, and critically evaluate strategic decisions by integrating functional areas, ethical considerations, and sustainability perspectives. Drawing on research-informed strategic frameworks and credible secondary sources, the project reflects a Research-Oriented Research–Teaching Nexus (RTN) approach that emphasizes inquiry-based strategic analysis rather than the production of original research.

In line with the Principles for Responsible Management Education (PRME) and United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 8, the project encourages responsible strategic thinking that links competitive performance with ethical decision-making and sustainable economic growth. The project is designed to develop strategic thinking while also assessing leadership, accountability, and teamwork expected of graduating business students.

PROJECT OUTCOMES

Through this project, you will learn how to examine an organization's resources, capabilities, and competitive position to make informed strategic choices. You will also develop the ability to evaluate strategic decisions by understanding how different functions work together, while considering ethical responsibilities and sustainability challenges in both local and global business environments.

PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

Section 1: Establish Vision and Mission

(Strategic Direction – Contextual Section)
Marks: 0 (No CLO-assessed)

Students are required to:

1. Introduce the organization and industry context
2. Present the organization's vision and mission
3. Explain strategic intent and long-term direction

Section 2: Strategy Formulation

(Collect, Analyze, and Prioritize Strategic Data)
Marks: 50

Students are required to:

4. Analyze organizational resources and capabilities
5. Evaluate competitive positioning
6. Apply appropriate strategic frameworks and matrices
7. Justify suitable business strategies

	Marks
Analysis of resources and capabilities	20
Assessment of competitive positioning	20
Appropriate use of strategic tools	10
Total (CLO 2)	50

Section 3: Strategy Implementation

(Structure, Resources, and Functional Integration)
Marks: 25

Students are required to:

8. Evaluate how strategies are implemented across functional areas
9. Discuss alignment between strategy, structure, and resources
10. Demonstrate coordination across functions

Criteria	Marks
Integration across functional areas	15
Alignment of strategy with structure and resources	10
Total (CLO 3)	25

Section 4: Strategy Evaluation, Ethics, and Sustainability

(Monitor Results, Take Corrective Actions, Adapt to Change)
Marks: 25

Students are required to:

11. Evaluate strategic decisions and outcomes
12. Assess ethical considerations and sustainability impact
13. Recommend corrective actions and improvements

Criteria	Marks
Evaluation of strategic decisions	10
Ethical and sustainability considerations	10
Quality of improvement recommendations	5
Total (CLO 3)	25



Rubric For Section 2: Strategy Formulation

Criterion	Marks	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Satisfactory
Analysis of organizational resources and capabilities	20	Comprehensive and insightful analysis showing clear link to competitive advantage	Clear and relevant analysis with minor gaps	Mostly descriptive with limited strategic insight	Basic identification with weak analysis
Assessment of competitive positioning	20	Strong understanding of industry position with clear strategic implications	Sound assessment with reasonable interpretation	Position identified but weak implications	Superficial or unclear positioning
Use of strategic frameworks and matrices	10	Appropriate selection and accurate application of tools, well integrated	Correct application with minor errors	Basic or partial application	Mechanical or weak use of tools

Rubric For Section 3: Strategy Implementation

Criterion	Marks	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Satisfactory
Integration across functional areas	15	Strong and coherent integration across functions	Good integration with minor gaps	Limited or uneven integration	Minimal integration across functions
Alignment of strategy, structure, and resources	10	Clear and convincing alignment explained	Alignment mostly clear	Alignment mentioned but weak	Poor or unclear alignment

Rubric For Section 4: Strategy Evaluation, Ethics, and Sustainability

Criterion	Marks	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Satisfactory
Evaluation of strategic decisions	10	Critical, balanced evaluation using multiple perspectives	Reasoned evaluation with some depth	Largely descriptive evaluation	Very limited evaluation
Ethical and sustainability considerations	10	Strong integration of ethics and sustainability into strategy	Relevant discussion with minor gaps	Mentioned but weakly integrated	Superficial or minimal consideration
Quality of improvement recommendations	5	Realistic, well-justified, and clearly linked to analysis	Appropriate but partially justified	General recommendations	Vague or poorly linked recommendations

Project Instructions:

Group Formation

- Students must work in groups of 2–4.
- Each student is expected to contribute meaningfully.
- Individual understanding will be assessed through presentations and Q&A.

Report Instructions

The report must be structured into FOUR sections only, as outlined below:

- Each section must not exceed 500 words.
- Add APA 7th Style References at the end of the report.
- Add Practice Exercises as Appendix at the end of the report after References.

Submission Details

- Submission Deadline: 25th March, 2026
- Total Words: 2,000-2500 inclusive of references.
- Submission Format: PDF
- Font Style, Size, and Spacing: Arial (Body CS); Font Size:12; double spacing
- Submission Mode: Upload on SULMS
- All students' work submitted to Turnitin Software should have a copy of the similarity index attached. These work examples consist of but are not limited to:
 - o Assignment, essay, report
 - o Research Project, thesis, and dissertation
 - o Graduation project/ Final Year Project
 - o Case study

Students are only permitted to submit their work to check the similarity index as per student level as follows:

- o For Level 4 students: up to two (2) times including the final submission.

Important Notes

- Plagiarism: Maximum plagiarism allowed 20%. For further details please read the policy available on SULMS under course details. Student work violating this condition will be addressed in accordance with the penalties outlined in the Student Academic Misconduct Conduct Policy.
- Use of AI in academic-related work AI may be used for proofreading and enhancing the readability of text, provided that the student or staff maintains responsibility for the original ideas and intellectual content. Any use of AI for these purposes must be disclosed and cited, either in the acknowledgment section or as a statement in the submission, explicitly mentioning the AI tool used and the nature of its assistance. The misuse of AI to artificially enhance

or generate content that misrepresents the student's or staff's efforts is strictly prohibited.

- Turnitin AI detection is a tool designed to indicate the likelihood of AI-generated content in a submission. A decision to consider whether the work involves improper use of AI must be based on an in-depth evaluation of the report produced by the system, ensuring that the originality of the student's and staff member's ideas and intellectual content is thoroughly assessed. Disclosure of any AI use, when permitted, is mandatory to maintain transparency and uphold academic integrity.
- Prohibited use of AI in academic-related work AI tools are not permitted in the following conditions unless explicitly allowed by the instructor
 - o All examinations or quizzes
 - o Assignments, essays, reports
 - o Research Projects, Theses or dissertations
 - o Graduation projects/ Final Year Project
 - o Case studies
- Penalties for a student's work in course assessments & Final year Project, which is deemed as partially or fully generated through the use of AI tools will be addressed in accordance with the Student Academic Misconduct Policy.
- A minimum of 05 high-quality academic references (peer-reviewed journal articles, books, and research papers) in APA format
- Consultation: Students are encouraged to consult with the instructor for guidance.